Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 5 2 ♥ Q J 5 2 ♦ K J 3 ♣ 8 2	
♠ Q 9 7 4 ♥ 10 3 ♦ A Q 10 7 ♣ 10 6 5		♠ J 3 ♥ 7 ♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2 ♣ J 9 4 3
	♠ K 10 8 ♥ A K 9 8 6 4 ♦ — ♣ A K Q 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠7

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 8 6 5 2 ♥ K J 10 7 ♦ — ♣ A 9 8 3	
♠ 10 3 ♥ Q 9 2 ♦ K Q 8 7 5 ♣ 10 7 2		♠ J ♥ A 6 5 4 3 ♦ J 10 9 4 ♣ 6 5 4
	♠ A Q 9 7 4 ♥ 8 ♦ A 6 3 2 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦K

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A 10 8 ♥ K 9 8 4 ♦ K 9 ♣ K 10 6 5	
♠ 3 2 ♥ J 3 2 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3 ♣ 8 4 3		♠ 9 7 6 5 4 ♥ Q 5 ♦ 10 5 2 ♣ A 7 2
	♠ K Q J ♥ A 10 7 6 ♦ A Q J ♣ Q J 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♥ by South
Lead: ♠3

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 4
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K Q J
♥ A J 10 7
♦ A 5
♣ K Q 10

♠ 5 3 2
♥ 4 3
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ A 7 6 4

♠ 10 9 8 6 4
♥ 6 2
♦ 10 8 3
♣ J 5 2

♠ 7
♥ K Q 9 8 5
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ 9 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣A

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 10 ♥ A K 9 8 4 ♦ K Q 8 ♣ K Q 6	
♠ 6 4 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ J 10 5 2 ♣ A 10 9 3	N W E S	♠ 9 8 2 ♥ Q 10 3 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ J 7 5 4
	♠ A Q J 7 5 3 ♥ 6 5 ♦ A 4 3 ♣ 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦J

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6♠.